State of the Web 2020–2025

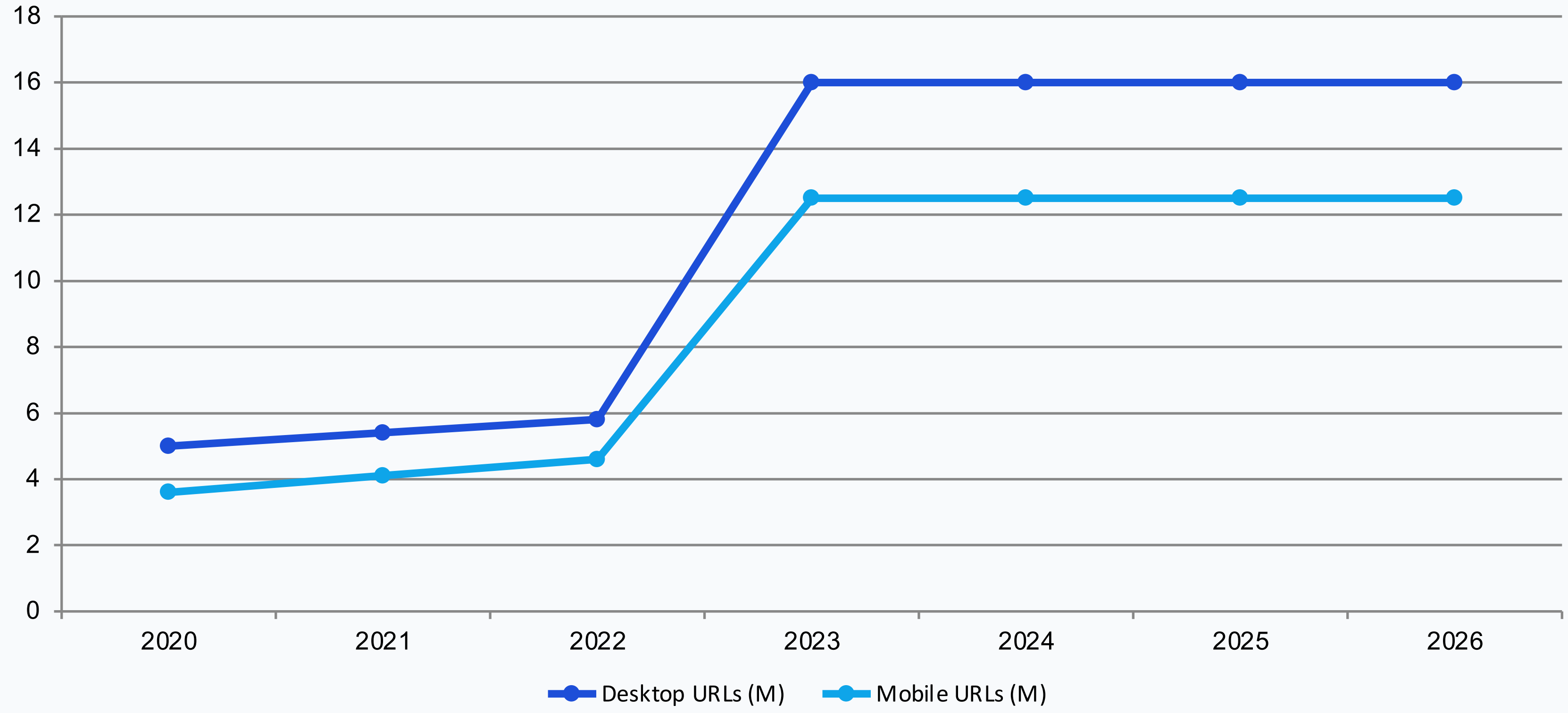
HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols, and Security

Data source: HTTP Archive
Time range: Jan 2020 – Mar 2026
Audience: Web performance engineers and front-end architects

Scope
- Crawl sample growth
- Page weight trends
- Requests & connections
- HTTPS and protocol shifts
- Font-display adoption

HTTP Archive baseline benchmarking deck

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020

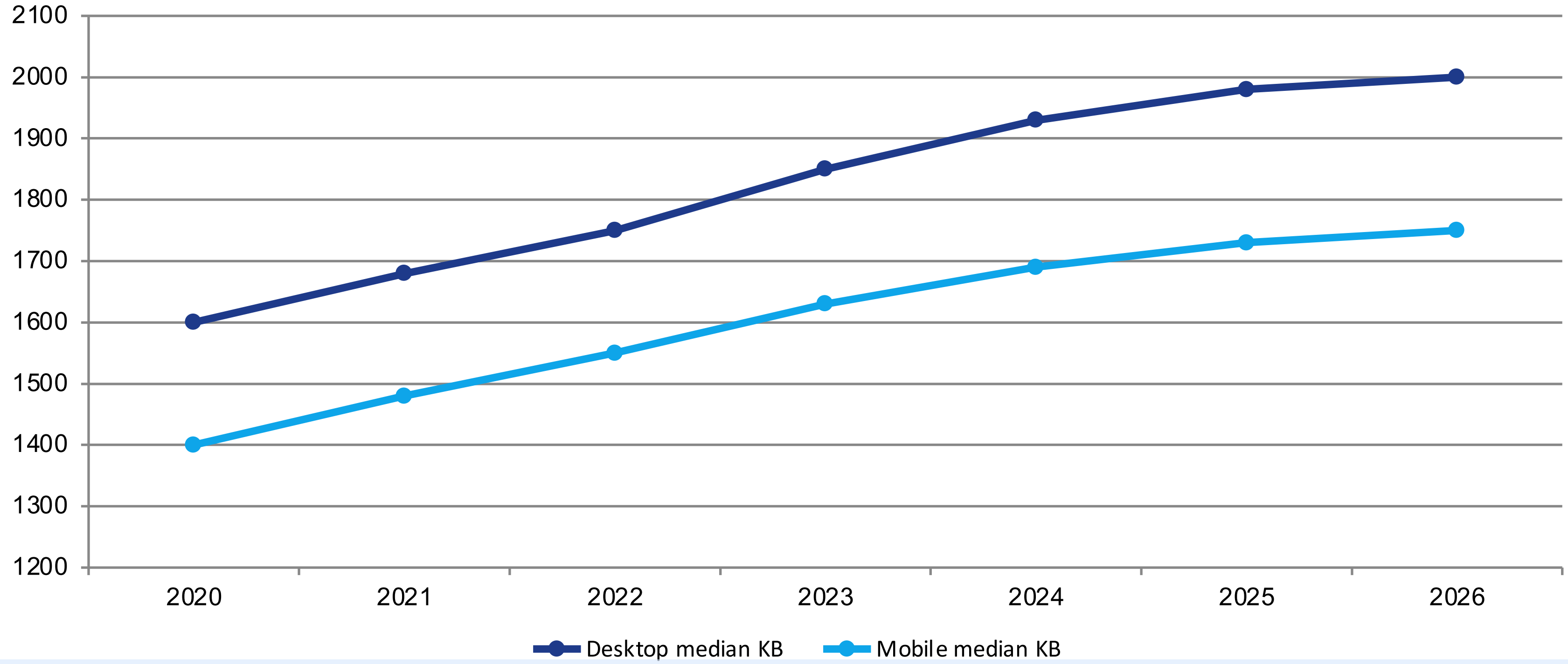


Desktop
~5M → 16M

Mobile
~3.6M → 12.5M

Sharp expansion occurs around mid-2022, then plateaus near 16M desktop and 12.5M mobile URLs.

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop



IQR band concept from source figure represented as confidence context

Desktop
~25% growth
(1,600 → 2,000 KB)

Mobile
Tracks below desktop
(~1,750 KB latest)

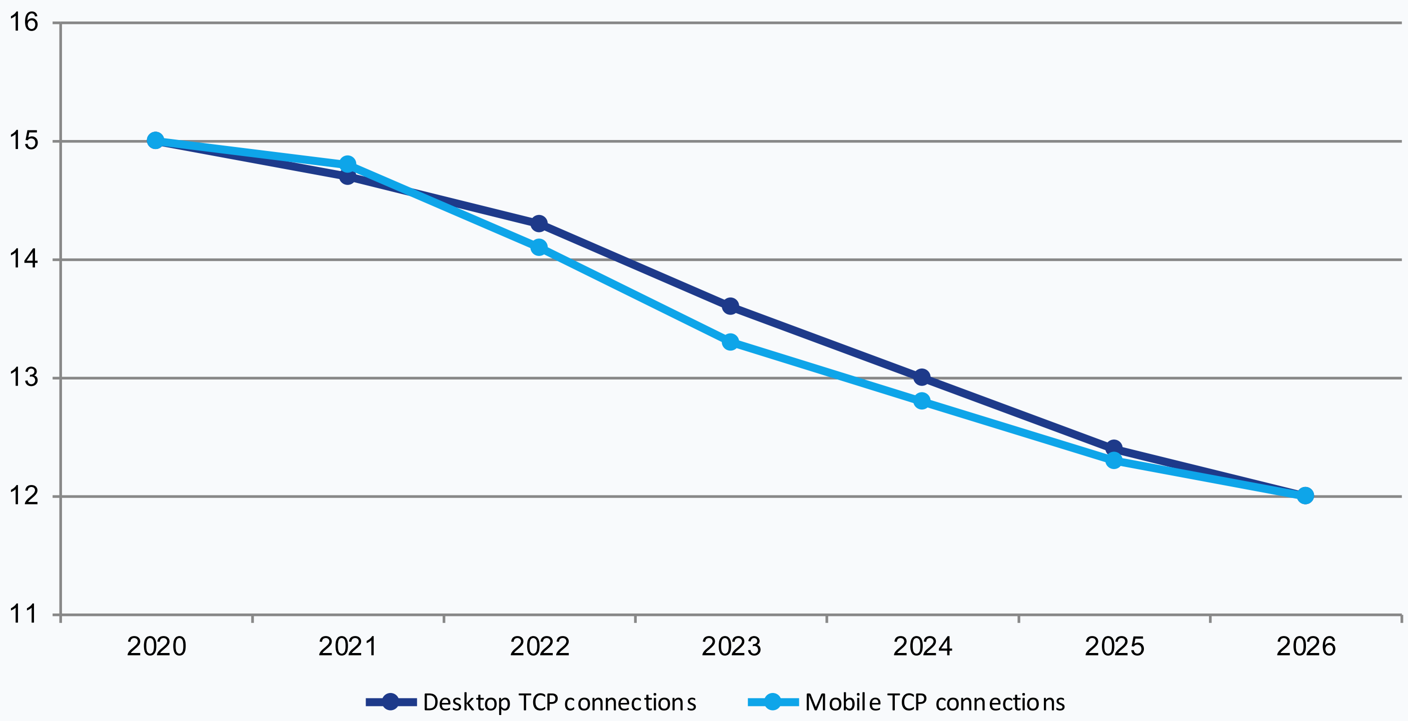
76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

Request Counts

76 Desktop

71 Mobile

Both are up ~3% vs 2020

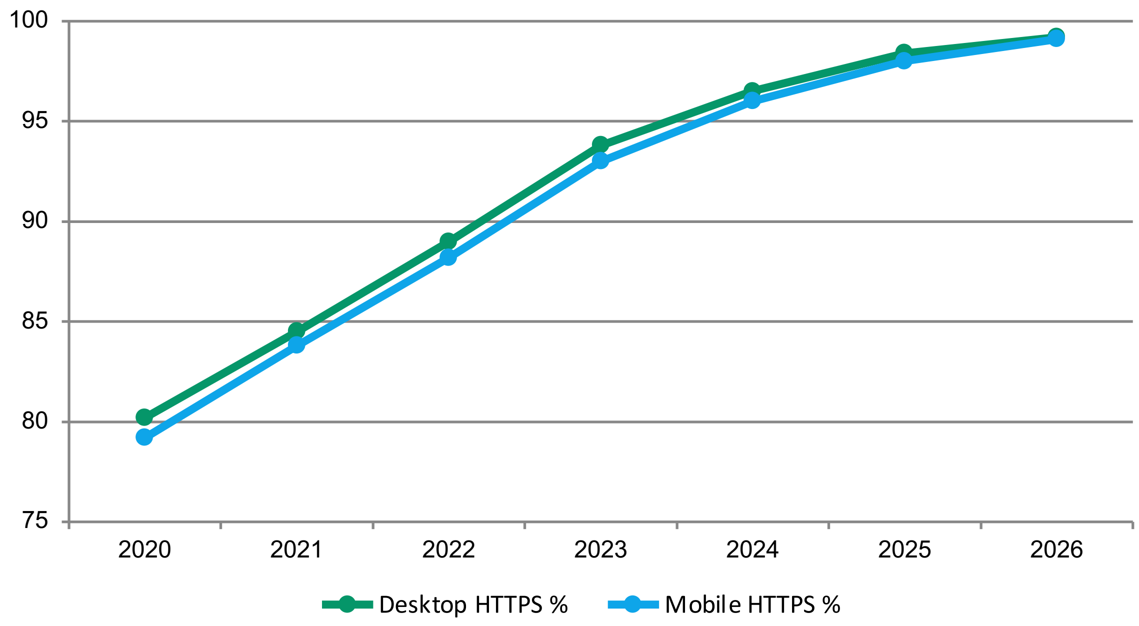


Declining connection counts indicate better multiplexing efficiency from HTTP/2 and HTTP/3.

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

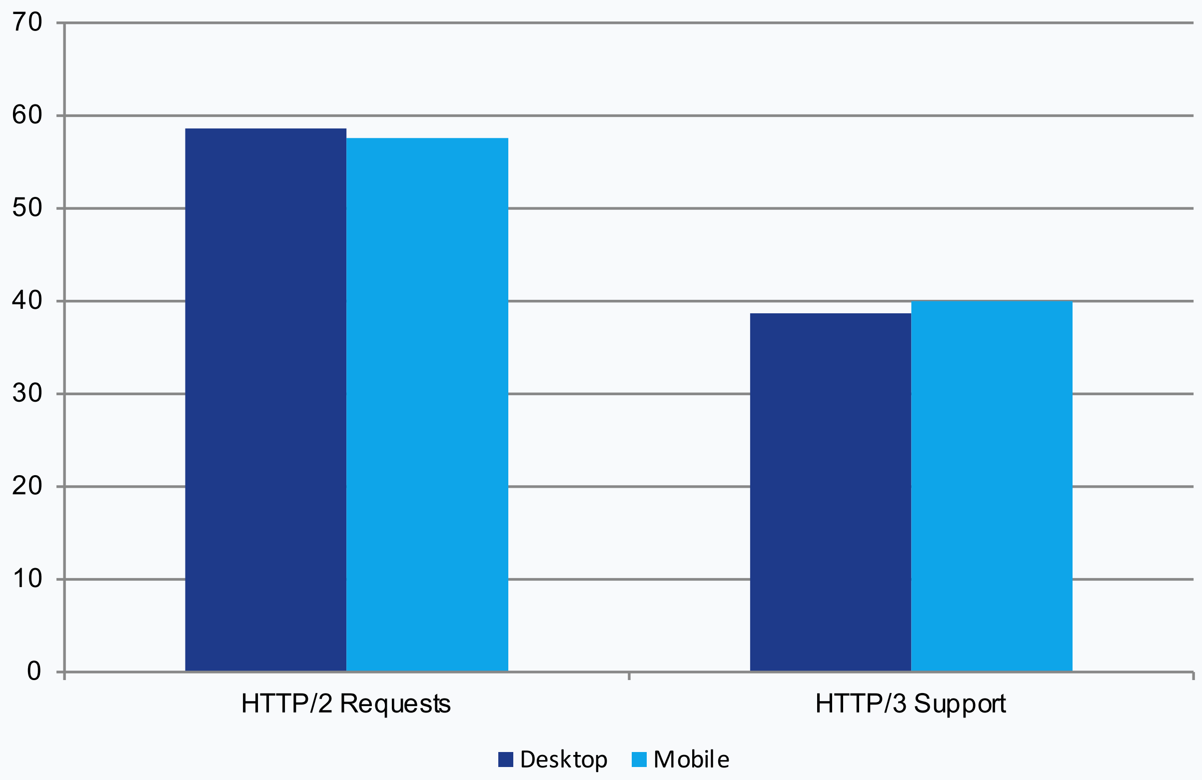
99%+

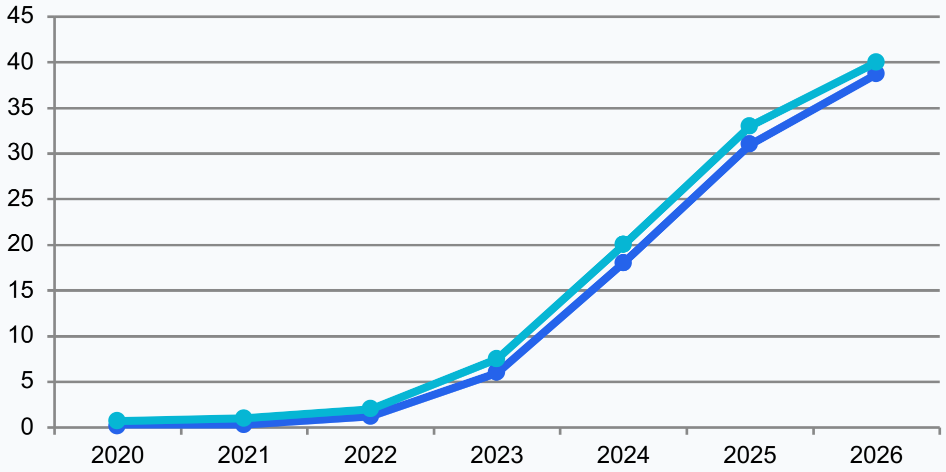
HTTPS request share
Desktop: 99.2%   Mobile: 99.1%



Plaintext HTTP is effectively gone from mainstream web traffic.

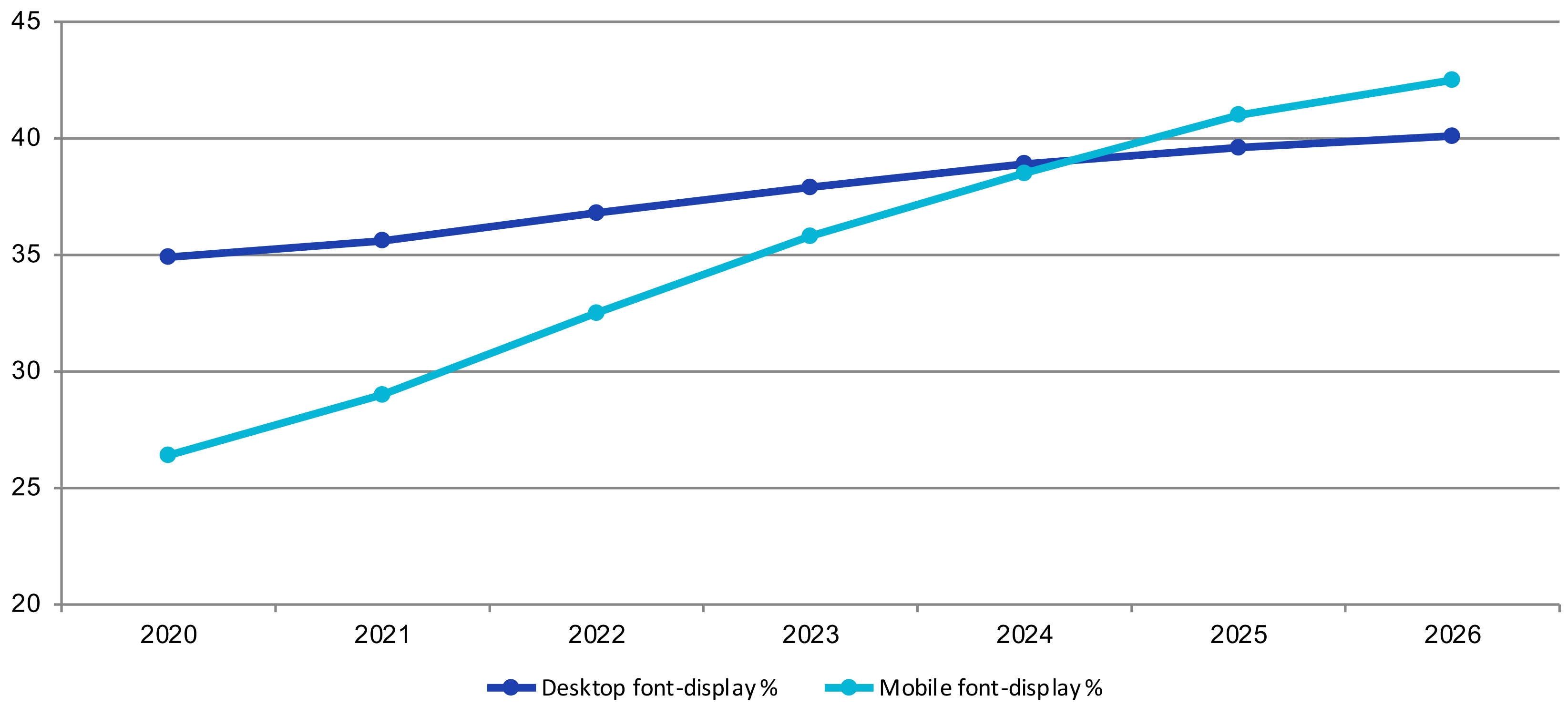
HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%





Caveat: HTTP Archive tracks HTTP/3 support (Alt-Svc capability), not first-connection usage in fresh Chrome sessions.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020



Desktop
40.1%
(+14.9%)

Mobile
42.5%
(+61.0%)

font-display mitigates FOIT, yet most pages still do not set it.

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

- Median desktop page weight rose from ~1,600 KB to ~2,000 KB (~25% growth).
- HTTPS is effectively universal: 99.2% desktop and 99.1% mobile requests.
- HTTP/3 support reached ~39–40%, while HTTP/2 remains near ~58%.
- TCP connections per page dropped from ~15 to ~12 despite higher request counts.
- font-display adoption improved to 40.1% desktop and 42.5% mobile, but remains underused.

Call to action: Benchmark your own pages against these baselines and prioritize protocol, payload, and rendering optimizations.